

associations, foundations, authorized physical persons, public institutions) on the condition of respecting the quota of 30% disabled workers. As there is no reference regarding the social economy principles in the legal regulations for sheltered workshops, in the recent report issued by Institute of Social Economy (CSDF) in August 2013¹⁸ it is considered that only sheltered workshops organized in traditional forms of social economy (associations, foundations, cooperatives) could be included in the field of work integration social enterprise. The sheltered workshops have the benefit of reserved markets as all employers in Romania have to either hire disabled employees or to buy services of goods from protected workshops. Sheltered workshops registered in Romania are in great majority for profit companies (69% from total, 391 sheltered workshops), some of the companies being also commercial subsidiaries of non-profit organisations (association or foundations). According to General Direction for Protection of Persons with Disabilities, legal forms assimilated to social economy represented in August 2012 only 23% in total sheltered workshops: 95 associations, 20 cooperatives and 14 foundations. At the end of 2012, sheltered workshops employed an approximate number of 4600 persons, from which approximate 2000 persons with disabilities, representing 42% in total employees for this type of organization, average close to legal condition of 30%. Besides the role of creating jobs for people with disabilities, according to the research results of IES report 2013, 47% of total sheltered workshops provide supplementary services for employees with disabilities like: professional training (27% from total sheltered workshops, 37% from sheltered workshops developed by social economy organizations), counseling and information services (14% from total sheltered workshops, 25% from sheltered workshops developed by social economy organization). The draft Law on Social Economy from September 2012 introduces a new category of social enterprises, work integration social enterprises which would lead to an extension of sheltered workshop activities towards work integration of other categories of vulnerable groups than the disabled and also incorporating the social economy principles in their operation, and without the benefit of the reserved markets.

3. Case study of a pilot rural territory where a comprehensive social economy start-up project has been developed Horezu Romania Idealis project. What would be the role of social economy in a territorial development in Horezu? Value chain analysis. The territory: general description and resources The territory - five localities from the South West Carpathian region in Romania – Horezu – a market town, and four rural municipalities Costesti, Vaideeni, Maldaresti and Slatioara as a strategic partnership “Oltenia at the feet of the Mountains – Partnership for Local Economic Development”. The Horezu micro region lies at 200 km away from Romania’s capital Bucharest, between the Căpățânii Mountains to the north, and little mountain rivers to the other parts. It is mainly a highland region, with mountains reaching altitudes of up to 2.124 m in the Ursul Peak, two rows of hills and depressionary corridors, among which stands out the Horezu Valley. Horezu, the market town around which the network of localities has evolved has a population of approximately 7,000 living in an area of 118 square kilometers. Horezu is reputed as an ethnographic centre and as an age-old folk ceramics centre, famous for well preserved traditions and crafts, rich cultural, spiritual and architectural heritage (old churches and monasteries, most famous traditional pottery centers in Romania) Traditional occupations include fruit production, animal rearing (bovines, goats, and sheep), ceramics/ pottery, and wood-processing industry. Horezu is also a traditional commercial centre; a market area for farming products and (household) utilities exchange. Finally, the name of Horezu is linked with the Monastery of Hurez, which is a monastic complex erected at the end of the XVII-th century, and which is listed in the UN World Heritage Site, a masterpiece of orthodox religious architecture, and also a cultural centre that influenced the development of crafts such as tapestry and ceramics in the region. The Horezu ethnographical area blends elements specific of several civilizations: the clay civilisation – famous potters, the wood civilization – talented wood-carvers and the pastoral civilization –on the alpine

¹⁸ Constantinescu St. (coord.), Social Economy and working force employment. Integration of vulnerable groups on labor market, Institute of Social Economy (CSDF), 2013